

Thriving in College

- **Overview:** Thriving begins with understanding the academic and cultural environment of your institution. STI promotes holistic growth that extends beyond technical knowledge to develop character, confidence, and communication.

Getting to Know STI

- **History & Evolution:** Founded in 1983 as a pioneer for computer literacy in the Philippines. Expanded from computer education into a nationwide network of colleges offering IT, business, health sciences, hospitality, tourism, arts, and engineering.
- **Core Purpose:** Evolved to nurture students who are academically prepared and future-ready, guided by lived core values.

STI 4Cs

- **Critical Thinking:** Analyzing information objectively, breaking down complex problems, identifying patterns, and making sound, reasoned judgments rather than just memorizing facts.
- **Communication:** Expressing ideas clearly through spoken, written, and non-verbal methods, alongside active listening. Adapts messages to suit the audience to build relationships, encourage teamwork, and achieve goals.
- **Change Adept:** Thriving in uncertainty, embracing innovation, and adapting quickly to new trends and challenges (reflected in blended learning and tech-based platforms).
- **Character:** Embodying integrity, honesty, fairness, ethical conduct, social responsibility, environmental care, and moral strength.
- **Impact:** The 4Cs are lifelong values that empower learners to become persons of purpose and potential in and out of the classroom.

Getting to Know My Student Identity

- **Shift in Identity:** College brings higher expectations, greater independence, and increased pressure. Understanding your student identity involves recognizing strengths/weaknesses, motivations, and habits that drive success.

Discovering Your Learning Style

- **Visual:** Understands concepts best when presented visually through drawings, charts, or graphs.
- **Auditory:** Learns best by listening and processing spoken information.
- **Read/Write:** Absorbs knowledge through reading and benefits greatly from detailed note-taking.
- **Kinesthetic:** Processes information best through direct physical involvement and hands-on experiences.

Adopting a Growth Mindset in College

- **Role of Mindset:** Based on psychologist Carol Dweck's research, how one views abilities, effort, and challenges determines whether a student merely survives or thrives in college.
- **Fixed Mindset (Limiting Growth):** Assumes intelligence and talents are innate and unchangeable.
 - *Avoids Challenges:* Skips difficult tasks or courses out of fear of failure.
 - *Rejects Failures/Mistakes:* Feels defeated by low marks instead of seeing them as learning opportunities.
 - *Believes Talent is Static:* Uses self-limiting statements like "I'm not a writer."
 - *Shies Away from the Unfamiliar:* Avoids joining clubs, internships, or leadership roles due to fear of the unknown.
- **Growth Mindset (Building Confidence Through Effort):** Grounded in the belief that abilities develop through effort, practice, and strategy.
 - *Views Challenges as Opportunities:* Takes on tough assignments to stretch potential.
 - *Embraces Constructive Feedback:* Uses professor critiques to revise and improve work.
 - *Learns from Failures:* Reassesses study habits and seeks tutoring after setbacks.
 - *Believes in Skill Development:* Cultivates new talents through practice and workshops.
- **Why Mindset Matters:** Knowing yourself, your learning style, and adopting a growth mindset prevents wasted effort, builds resilience, and turns failures into fuel for progress.

Peer Support

- **Definition:** Mutual assistance (academic or emotional) given and received among classmates (e.g., study groups, sharing notes, encouraging presentation prep).
- **Benefits:** Reduces isolation, strengthens a sense of belonging, and fosters a culture of cooperation over competition.

Go-to Person

- **Definition:** A trusted individual (blockmate, peer mentor, student leader) turned to for guidance, help, or advice.
- **Role:** Helps clear up confusion (e.g., accessing modules, navigating group project dynamic conflicts) and reduces hesitation in seeking assistance.

Building Supportive Peer Connections

- **Strategies:** Show respect, openness, and approachability; include quiet classmates; avoid gossip; practice active listening.
- **Accountability:** Submit group work on time, communicate limitations honestly, set healthy boundaries, and help others selflessly.
- **Closing Insight:** College success is built on shared effort, mutual respect, and knowing when to reach out—when students lift each other, everyone rises.